

So essentially, in most scenarios that include logical failures such as accidental file deletions, formatting, power failures, virus attacks etc., you don't need to be a computer expert to be able to recover your data safely and inexpensively. Just make sure that you use recovery tools and not repair tools that might write to the disk. However, there are some cases when data recovery software just won't cut it, which brings us to the next question you may have...

When do I need to go to a professional?

There are cases where the drive stops functioning because of a physical problem with it – the drive isn't spinning or is making strange noises. When a hard drive is physically damaged, software solutions won't help you. You're then left with no other option except turning it in to a data recovery expert.

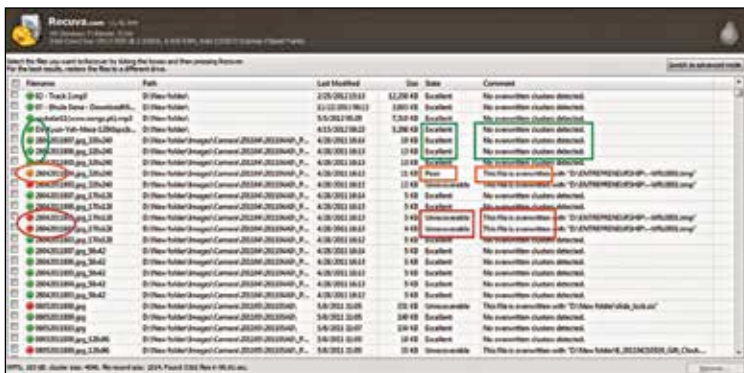
Worst case - you can get professionals to recover your data for you.jpg
Caption: Worst case - you can get professionals to recover your data for you

Be advised, however, that most of these recovery processes end up being an expensive affair with the price usually depending on the amount of data that must be recovered.

Free recovery software

Here's to hoping, though, that your data recovery problem can be solved at home using software. Listed below are some few free software that we think can possibly be the solution to your problems:

1. **Recuva (Windows):** Arguably, the best free file recovery software that's available. It can recover files from your hard disk, external hard disks,



Recuva shows how some files are unrecoverable